



Delivery Outcomes & Agile Principles

Week 7 • Day 1 • Agile Delivery & ADO Mastery

TPM Academy



Day 1 Objectives

- Distinguish **outputs** (what we shipped) from **outcomes** (what changed for the user/business)
- Apply the **Agile Manifesto values** as a decision-making aid — not as ceremony
- Build an **outcome map** for your feature, tied to NS / Tier Sheet
- Name **counter-outcomes** — the guardrails against winning for the wrong reasons
- Draft **DP §1 — Outcome Map**



Today's Shape

Clock	Block	Outcome
09:00 – 09:15	Opening	Pin the artifact set (PRD/TCD/TMD/SEP)
09:15 – 10:30	Block 1 + Activity 1	Output / Outcome sort
10:45 – 12:00	Block 2 + Activity 2	Build your outcome map
13:00 – 14:15	Block 3 + Activity 3	Agile values in trade-offs
14:30 – 16:00	Block 4 + Activity 4 + Wrap	Cross-review + AI sanity

Block 1 — Output vs Outcome

The foundational distinction



Output vs Outcome

Output	Outcome
What we built / shipped	What changed for user / business
"Reconcile flow shipped July 15"	"Dispatchers spend 30 min less per shift"
Easy to measure	Harder to measure
Can be hit while losing	If hit, you actually won

The most common shipping-but-failing pattern: the team can hit all outputs and miss all outcomes.



The Discipline

- Every **output** maps to one or more **outcomes**
- Every outcome has at least one **leading indicator** (Day 3)
- If you can hit the outputs but not move any outcome, the work is **theatre**

Watch for: "we delivered all 23 user stories in the sprint." That's an output statement. Where's the outcome?

Activity 1 — Output / Outcome Sort

Triads • 35 minutes

12 statements. Label each: Output / Outcome / Both / Neither. Argue when you disagree. Rewrite the "Both"-labeled ones cleanly.

- 15 min: label all 12
- 15 min: argue + rewrite
- 5 min: readout prep



15 + 15 + 5

Block 2 — Build Your Outcome Map

Primary + supporting + counter-outcomes



Outcome Map Structure

```
### Primary outcome
<user-visible outcome>
Tied to: <NS / KPI from Tier Sheet>
Target movement: <baseline → target> by <timeline>
Leading indicator: <what we'd watch first>

### Supporting outcomes (2-4)
For each: <outcome> / Tied to: ... / Why it matters: ...

### Counter-outcomes (the guardrails)
<outcome we DON'T want – if this happens, we won for the
wrong reasons>

### What this feature explicitly does NOT outcome on
<claims we are NOT making – usually pulled from PRD §3 non-goals>
```



Worked Outcome Map (FieldPulse)

Primary: Median dispatcher reconcile time drops from 45 min to ≤ 12 min within 30 days of launch.

Tied to: Tier Sheet primary metric.

Leading: % of reconcile-flow runs that complete on first attempt (target $\geq 80\%$ by week 2).

<p>Supporting:</p>

Reconcile-flow abandonment drops to $\leq 5\%$

Manual override entries per dispatcher drop $\geq 50\%$

Mobile reconcile adoption climbs to $\geq 70\%$ of accounts

<p>Counter-outcome: Support tickets about reconcile flow rise</p>

<blockquote>

<p>20%. (If we won the primary by adding new pain.)</p>

</blockquote>

<p>Explicitly NOT outcoming on:</p>

Tablet adoption (out of scope this iteration)

- Multi-shop manager view metrics (different feature)

Activity 2 — Build Your Outcome Map

Triads • 40 minutes

- 10 min: pull primary outcome from NS / Tier Sheet
- 10 min: list supporting outcomes (2–4)
- 10 min: name counter-outcomes
- 5 min: name "explicitly NOT"
- 5 min: each outcome has a Tier Sheet metric attached



10 + 10 + 10 + 5 + 5

Block 3 — Agile Manifesto as Decision Aid

Values, not ceremony



The Four Values

1. **Individuals and interactions** over processes and tools
2. **Working software** over comprehensive documentation
3. **Customer collaboration** over contract negotiation
4. **Responding to change** over following a plan

"While there is value in the items on the right, we value the items on the left more."

What the Manifesto DOESN'T Say

- **Not "no documentation"** — PRDs/TCDs/TMDs/SEPs are valuable; they support working software
- **Not "no plans"** — plans are essential; rigid adherence isn't
- **Not "no process"** — processes serve people; people don't serve processes
- **Not "stand-ups daily"** — the Manifesto says nothing about meetings



6 Principles to Internalize

1. **Satisfy through early/continuous delivery** — small frequent shipments
2. **Welcome changing requirements, even late** — change is information
3. **Deliver working software frequently** — weeks, not months
4. **Business and developers work together daily** — the TPM is the bridge
5. **Continuous attention to technical excellence** — speed without quality is cowardice
6. **Self-organizing teams produce best results** — top-down task assignment is a smell

Activity 3 — Agile Values in Trade-offs

Triads • 40 minutes

4 trade-off scenarios. For each: name the value, what it implies, what it does NOT imply, your decision.

- 32 min: 4 scenarios × 8 min each
- 8 min: synthesis — which value did your triad invoke most?



$$8 \times 4 + 8$$

Block 4 — Cross-Review + AI Sanity

Catch outputs masquerading as outcomes



Cross-Review Questions

1. Is each "outcome" actually an outcome, or a dressed-up output?
2. Do supporting outcomes overlap?
3. Is the counter-outcome specific enough to detect a real cheat?
4. What outcome is missing?

AI Sanity Check

```
Role: Senior PM coaching outcome thinking.  
Context: <paste the="" outcome="" map="">  
Task: Identify where outputs are masquerading as outcomes,  
where outcomes are too vague to measure, and any  
counter-outcome that could be gamed.  
Constraints:  
- Be specific to statements given  
- Suggest a concrete rewrite  
Format: 3 numbered findings.</paste>
```

Activity 4 — Cross-Review + AI

Triad pairs • 45 minutes • Wrap

- 20 min: cross-review with 4 questions
- 15 min: author-triad revisions
- 10 min: AI sanity check + adopt/defer/reject



20 + 15 + 10 • 15-min wrap



Day 1 Wrap

What we built

- Output/outcome distinction
- Outcome map (primary + supporting + counter)
- Agile values as decision aid
- Cross-reviewed + AI-checked
- DP §1 drafted

What opens tomorrow

- **ADO Usage (hands-on)**
- Epic → Feature → User Story → Task
- Field discipline; queries; flow charts
- Bring your laptop

Bring to Day 2: DP §1 + ADO access. Tomorrow we load the backlog.

Questions & Reflection

Which output are you currently chasing because it's measurable, even though it's not the outcome?